

How did the Nazis consolidate their power? ▼ (<https://www.theholocaustexplained.org/the-nazi-rise-to-power/how-did-the-nazi-gain-power/>)

Subtopics: The Reichstag Fire (<https://www.theholocaustexplained.org/the-nazi-rise-to-power/how-did-the-nazi-gain-power/reichstag-fire/>) Emergency

How did the Nazi consolidate their power?

Following Hitler's appointment as chancellor the Nazis were finally in a position of power.

However, this power was limited, as the Nazis were just one party in a three party coalition (A temporary union of political parties.) government, under President Hindenburg.

This topic will explore how the Nazis managed to eliminate their opposition and consolidate (To make something stronger.) ultimate power over Germany, whilst maintaining an illusion (A false appearance or impression.) of democracy.

It will first explore this topic in chronological order, from the Reichstag Fire through to the death of President Hindenburg, and then explore it thematically in the last section.

(<https://www.facebook.com/sharer/sharer.php?u=https%3A%2F%2Fwww.theholocaustexplained.org%2Fthe-nazi-rise-to-power%2Fhow-did-the-nazi-gain-power%2Fgleichschaltung%2F>)
(<http://twitter.com/intent/tweet?text=Gleichschaltung&url=https%3A%2F%2Fwww.theholocaustexplained.org%2Fthe-nazi-rise-to-power%2Fhow-did-the-nazi-gain-power%2Fgleichschaltung%2F>)
 (<https://mail.google.com/mail/?ui=2&view=cm&fs=1&tf=1&su=Gleichschaltung&body=Link:https%3A%2F%2Fwww.theholocaustexplained.org%2Fthe-nazi-rise-to-power%2Fhow-did-the-nazi-gain-power%2Fgleichschaltung%2F>)

The Reichstag Fire



On the 31 January 1933, Hitler, conscious of his lack of a majority in the Reichstag, immediately called for new elections to try and strengthen his position. The Nazis aimed to increase their share of the vote so that they would have a majority in the Reichstag. This would allow them to rule unopposed and unhindered by coalition governments.

Over the next two months, they launched themselves into an intense election campaign.

On 27 February 1933, as the campaign moved into its final, frantic days, the Reichstag, the German Parliament building, was set on fire and burnt down. An atmosphere of panic and terror followed the event.

This continued when a young Dutch communist, Van der Lubbe was arrested for the crime.

The Nazi Party used the atmosphere of panic to their advantage, encouraging anti-communism. Göring declared that the communists had planned a national uprising to overthrow the Weimar Republic. This hysteria helped to turn the public against the communists, one of the Nazis main opponents, and 4000 people were imprisoned.

The day after the fire, Hindenburg signed the Emergency Decree for the Protection of the German People.

(<https://www.facebook.com/sharer/sharer.php?u=https%3A%2F%2Fwww.theholocaustexplained.org%2Fthe-nazi-rise-to-power%2Fhow-did-the-nazi-gain-power%2Fgleichschaltung%2F>)
 (<http://twitter.com/intent/tweet?text=Gleichschaltung&url=https%3A%2F%2Fwww.theholocaustexplained.org%2Fthe-nazi-rise-to-power%2Fhow-did-the-nazi-gain-power%2Fgleichschaltung%2F>)
 (mailto:https://mail.google.com/mail/?ui=2&view=cm&fs=1&tf=1&su=Gleichschaltung&body=Link:https%3A%2F%2Fwww.theholocaustexplained.org%2Fthe-nazi-rise-to-power%2Fhow-did-the-nazi-gain-power%2Fgleichschaltung%2F)

Emergency powers

The day after the Reichstag fire, the 28 February 1933, Hindenburg signed a decree giving Hitler emergency powers. This photograph was taken the same day, showing the Reichstag still burning.

Courtesy of The Wiener Holocaust Library (<https://www.wienerlibrary.co.uk/>) Collections.

On the 28 February 1933, President Hindenburg signed the Emergency Decree for the Protection of the German People. This decree suspended the democratic aspects of the Weimar Republic and declared a state of emergency.

This decree gave the Nazis a legal basis for the

persecution (The act of continually treating a group of people in a cruel or harsh way, often because of race, religion, political ideas, or some other difference.)

and oppression (To continuously treat people unjustly and harshly.) of any opponents, who were be framed as traitors to the republic. People could be imprisoned for any or no reason.

The decree also removed basic personal freedoms, such as the freedom of speech, the right to own property, and the right to trial before imprisonment.

Through these aspects the Nazis suppressed any opposition to their power, and were able to start the road from democracy to a dictatorship.

(<https://www.facebook.com/sharer/sharer.php?u=https%3A%2F%2Fwww.theholocaustexplained.org%2Fthe-nazi-rise-to-power%2Fhow-did-the-nazi-gain-power%2Fgleichschaltung%2F>)
(<http://twitter.com/intent/tweet?text=Gleichschaltung&url=https%3A%2F%2Fwww.theholocaustexpla>

nazi-rise-to-power%2Fhow-did-the-nazi-gain-power%2Fgleichschaltu
✉(https://mail.google.com/mail/?
ui=2&view=cm&fs=1&tf=1&su=Gleichschaltung&body=Link:https%3A/
nazi-rise-to-power%2Fhow-did-the-nazi-gain-power%2Fgleichschaltu

Elections 1933

A poster from the March 1933 elections. The bottom half of the poster reads 'The more power you give Hitler, the easier he will win and the more independent you make him from the parties that led the people to where they are today. You gave these parties 14 years to ruin Germany! Give Hitler four years to rebuild it! You give Hitler power and time by voting HITLER!'

Courtesy of The Wiener Holocaust Library (<https://www.wienerlibrary.co.uk/>) Collections.

The atmosphere of uncertainty following the Reichstag Fire secured many voters for the Nazi party.

The SA also ran a violent campaign of terror against any and all opponents of the Nazi regime. Many were terrified of voting of at all, and many turned to voting for the Nazi Party out of fear for their own safety. The elections were neither free or fair.

On the 5 March 1933, the elections took place, with an extremely high turnout of 89%.

The Nazis secured 43.9% of the vote, an improvement of almost 10% on the previous November's election. Despite this improvement, the Nazis still did not command a majority in the Reichstag.

([https://www.facebook.com/sharer/sharer.php?
u=https%3A%2F%2Fwww.theholocaustexplained.org%2Fthe-
nazi-rise-to-power%2Fhow-did-the-nazi-gain-
power%2Fgleichschaltung%2F](https://www.facebook.com/sharer/sharer.php?u=https%3A%2F%2Fwww.theholocaustexplained.org%2Fthe-nazi-rise-to-power%2Fhow-did-the-nazi-gain-power%2Fgleichschaltung%2F))

([http://twitter.com/intent/tweet?](http://twitter.com/intent/tweet?text=Gleichschaltung&url=https%3A%2F%2Fwww.theholocaustexplained.org%2Fthe-nazi-rise-to-power%2Fhow-did-the-nazi-gain-power%2Fgleichschaltung%2F)
[text=Gleichschaltung&url=https%3A%2F%2Fwww.theholocaustexplained.org%2Fthe-nazi-rise-to-power%2Fhow-did-the-nazi-gain-power%2Fgleichschaltung%2F](http://twitter.com/intent/tweet?text=Gleichschaltung&url=https%3A%2F%2Fwww.theholocaustexplained.org%2Fthe-nazi-rise-to-power%2Fhow-did-the-nazi-gain-power%2Fgleichschaltung%2F)
 ([https://mail.google.com/mail/?](https://mail.google.com/mail/?ui=2&view=cm&fs=1&tf=1&su=Gleichschaltung&body=Link:https%3A%2F%2Fwww.theholocaustexplained.org%2Fthe-nazi-rise-to-power%2Fhow-did-the-nazi-gain-power%2Fgleichschaltung%2F)
[ui=2&view=cm&fs=1&tf=1&su=Gleichschaltung&body=Link:https%3A%2F%2Fwww.theholocaustexplained.org%2Fthe-nazi-rise-to-power%2Fhow-did-the-nazi-gain-power%2Fgleichschaltung%2F](https://mail.google.com/mail/?ui=2&view=cm&fs=1&tf=1&su=Gleichschaltung&body=Link:https%3A%2F%2Fwww.theholocaustexplained.org%2Fthe-nazi-rise-to-power%2Fhow-did-the-nazi-gain-power%2Fgleichschaltung%2F)

The Enabling Law

On the 23 March 1933, Hitler proposed the Enabling Law to the Reichstag. This new law gave Hitler the power to rule by decree rather than passing laws through the Reichstag and the president. If passed, the law would establish the conditions needed for dictatorial rule.

The atmosphere of terror that had followed the Reichstag Fire, and Hindenburg's and von Papen's support, made the proposal seem legitimate and, to some, necessary.

The law needed two thirds of the Reichstag to vote for it to pass. The Nazi's had the support of the DNVP, and had banned the communist party, the KPD, from attending.

The SA and the SS had also been on a month long campaign of violence to scare or imprison other opponents to the party. They had placed many in the first concentration camp (Concentration camps are where groups of people are held under armed guard outside of any judicial process for an indefinite period of time. Camp prisoners are sometimes made to complete forced labour. The Nazis built hundreds of these camps all over Europe. These camps were unsanitary, overcrowded and brutal. Concentration camps were for civilians used prior to the Nazi era, for example in the Boer War.)

Dachau (The first Nazi concentration camp opened on 22 March 1933 in the grounds of an abandoned factory. The camp was initially created to hold political prisoners, but soon expanded to hold all Nazi prisoners. Dachau had approximately 100 sub camps. It was liberated on the 29 April 1945.)

, which opened just a few days before the vote on the 20 March 1933.

The Centre Party's vote was crucial. After Hitler had promised to protect the interests of the Catholic Church, the party conceded and supported the bill. Only the SPD opposed it.

The Bill passed by 444 votes for to 94 against on the 24 March 1933.

Although President Hindenburg and the Reichstag continued to exist, Hitler could now govern by decree.

([https://www.facebook.com/sharer/sharer.php?](https://www.facebook.com/sharer/sharer.php?u=https%3A%2F%2Fwww.theholocaustexplained.org%2Fthe-nazi-rise-to-power%2Fhow-did-the-nazi-gain-power%2Fgleichschaltung%2F)
[u=https%3A%2F%2Fwww.theholocaustexplained.org%2Fthe-nazi-rise-to-power%2Fhow-did-the-nazi-gain-power%2Fgleichschaltung%2F](https://www.facebook.com/sharer/sharer.php?u=https%3A%2F%2Fwww.theholocaustexplained.org%2Fthe-nazi-rise-to-power%2Fhow-did-the-nazi-gain-power%2Fgleichschaltung%2F))
([http://twitter.com/intent/tweet?](http://twitter.com/intent/tweet?text=Gleichschaltung&url=https%3A%2F%2Fwww.theholocaustexplained.org%2Fthe-nazi-rise-to-power%2Fhow-did-the-nazi-gain-power%2Fgleichschaltung%2F)
[text=Gleichschaltung&url=https%3A%2F%2Fwww.theholocaustexplained.org%2Fthe-nazi-rise-to-power%2Fhow-did-the-nazi-gain-power%2Fgleichschaltung%2F](http://twitter.com/intent/tweet?text=Gleichschaltung&url=https%3A%2F%2Fwww.theholocaustexplained.org%2Fthe-nazi-rise-to-power%2Fhow-did-the-nazi-gain-power%2Fgleichschaltung%2F)
 ([https://mail.google.com/mail/?](https://mail.google.com/mail/?ui=2&view=cm&fs=1&tf=1&su=Gleichschaltung&body=Link:https%3A%2F%2Fwww.theholocaustexplained.org%2Fthe-nazi-rise-to-power%2Fhow-did-the-nazi-gain-power%2Fgleichschaltung%2F)
[ui=2&view=cm&fs=1&tf=1&su=Gleichschaltung&body=Link:https%3A%2F%2Fwww.theholocaustexplained.org%2Fthe-nazi-rise-to-power%2Fhow-did-the-nazi-gain-power%2Fgleichschaltung%2F](https://mail.google.com/mail/?ui=2&view=cm&fs=1&tf=1&su=Gleichschaltung&body=Link:https%3A%2F%2Fwww.theholocaustexplained.org%2Fthe-nazi-rise-to-power%2Fhow-did-the-nazi-gain-power%2Fgleichschaltung%2F)

The Night of Long Knives

Röhm is pictured here on the left next to Rudolf Hess, who was the deputy Führer from 1933-1941.

Courtesy of The Wiener Holocaust Library (<https://www.wienerlibrary.co.uk/>) Collections.

The Night of Long Knives, also known as the Röhm Putsch, was the purge of the SA leadership and other political opponents from 30 June 1934 to 2 July 1934. Carried out primarily by the SS and the Gestapo, over 150 people were murdered and hundreds more were arrested.

In August 1932 there were approximately 445,000 members of the SA. By June 1934 this had grown to over 3,000,000 members. They were often given a free rein on their activities and were violent and difficult to control.

Hitler feared that the SA and Ernst Röhm, their leader, were a potential threat to his leadership. This fear was intensified (To become or to make something more intense.) by Göring and Himmler, who gave Hitler news of Röhm organising a potential coup (An illegal and usually violent seizure of power.) .

In addition to this, there was a mutual dislike between the traditional conservative elite – who maintained many key positions in the government and the army during the first years of the Third Reich – and the SA. During the years of the rise of the Nazi Party, the SA had been instrumental in helping the party to gain support.

However, following Hitler being elected chancellor, the SA, and particularly Röhm, were keen to continue the 'revolution' and replace the traditional conservative elite with Nazis. Hitler and the rest of the Nazi leadership disagreed with their approach. They understood the need to appear moderate and take over slowly by democratic means where possible, maintaining the stability and illusion of a democracy. The tension between the SA and the Nazi leadership grew.

On 30 June 1934 these tensions came to a head. The leaders of the SA were ordered to attend a meeting at a hotel in Bad Wiessee, Bavaria. Hitler arrived and personally placed Röhm and other high ranking SA leaders under arrest.

Over the next two days, most of the SA leadership were placed under arrest and murdered without trial. Röhm, who was initially pardoned (To be excused from the legal consequences of an offence.) , was then given the choice of suicide or murder. Refusing to take his own life, he was shot on 1 July 1934 by two SS guards.

Whilst the purge focused on the SA, the Nazis also used the event to eliminate other political opponents, such as the former chancellor Kurt von Schleicher.

The Night of the Long Knives (in addition to [Hindenburg's death \(https://www.theholocaustexplained.org/the-nazi-rise-to-power/how-did-the-nazi-gain-power/death-of-hindenburg/\)](https://www.theholocaustexplained.org/the-nazi-rise-to-power/how-did-the-nazi-gain-power/death-of-hindenburg/) a few months later) helped Hitler and the Nazi Party to consolidate absolute power in Germany by removing their political opposition.

From 20 August onwards, the

Reichswehr (The Weimar Republic's official state army. It was formed in 1919 and limited to 100,000 men, as per the terms of the Treaty of Versailles. In 1935, the Reichswehr was united with the Wehrmacht.)

, who had previously been a separate organisation, now swore a personal allegiance to Hitler. The SA were dramatically reduced in size, dropping by 40% to 1.8 million by 1935.

Goebbels engineered the media coverage following the attack to present it as a preventative measure, in response to the SA's 'plan to overthrow the government'. As the SA were known for being violent and unruly, many saw this as a legitimate move by the government to ensure public order.

On 13 July 1934 the Reichstag retrospectively (Looking back on or dealing with past events or situations.) approved a bill legalising the purge as emergency defence measures.

(<https://www.facebook.com/sharer/sharer.php?u=https%3A%2F%2Fwww.theholocaustexplained.org%2Fthe-nazi-rise-to-power%2Fhow-did-the-nazi-gain-power%2Fgleichschaltung%2F>)
(<http://twitter.com/intent/tweet?text=Gleichschaltung&url=https%3A%2F%2Fwww.theholocaustexplained.org%2Fthe-nazi-rise-to-power%2Fhow-did-the-nazi-gain-power%2Fgleichschaltung%2F>)
 (<https://mail.google.com/mail/?ui=2&view=cm&fs=1&tf=1&su=Gleichschaltung&body=Link:https%3A%2F%2Fwww.theholocaustexplained.org%2Fthe-nazi-rise-to-power%2Fhow-did-the-nazi-gain-power%2Fgleichschaltung%2F>)

Gleichschaltung

Gleichschaltung was the process of the Nazi Party taking control over all aspects of Germany. It is otherwise known as coordination or Nazification. The process primarily took place between 1933-1934.

The Nazis started with the

Civil Service (The umbrella term for all government departments which help the administrative running of government, excluding the armed forces. Examples of civil service roles include judges and doctors.)

, issuing the Act for the Restoration of the Professional Civil Service on the 7 April 1933. This act legalised removing anyone of non-Aryan descent from the civil service.

In the judicial system specifically, this act removed any judges that were deemed non-compliant with Nazi laws or principles. This act was reinforced by the German Civil Service code of 26 January 1937, which retired any judges or judicial official who would not intervene in cases and rule in favour of the Nazis. The People's Court, a court created by the Nazis in April 1934 with judges chosen specifically for their Nazi beliefs, replaced the Supreme Court. With these measures in place, the Nazification of the judicial system was complete.

Gleichschaltung was applied across every possible aspect of government policy.

To take control of cultural policy, the Nazis appointed Joseph Goebbels as Minister for Public Engagement and Propaganda on the 13 March 1933. Goebbels became responsible for controlling the national media, film, theatre, arts, and other cultural aspects. Goebbels soon radicalised each of these areas, ensuring that they advocated Nazi ideas.

Whilst *Gleichschaltung* aimed to reach every aspect of rule in Germany, this was not always possible. Local governments proved more difficult to infiltrate, and even at the end of 1945 only 60% of local mayors were Nazi Party members.

Despite this, on the whole, *Gleichschaltung* was largely successful. By the end of 1934, the Nazis had managed to infiltrate and take control of every major aspect of German government.

(<https://www.facebook.com/sharer/sharer.php?u=https%3A%2F%2Fwww.theholocaustexplained.org%2Fthe-nazi-rise-to-power%2Fhow-did-the-nazi-gain-power%2Fgleichschaltung%2F>)
(<http://twitter.com/intent/tweet?text=Gleichschaltung&url=https%3A%2F%2Fwww.theholocaustexplained.org%2Fthe-nazi-rise-to-power%2Fhow-did-the-nazi-gain-power%2Fgleichschaltung%2F>)
 (<https://mail.google.com/mail/?ui=2&view=cm&fs=1&tf=1&su=Gleichschaltung&body=Link:https%3A%2F%2Fwww.theholocaustexplained.org%2Fthe-nazi-rise-to-power%2Fhow-did-the-nazi-gain-power%2Fgleichschaltung%2F>)

The death of President Hindenburg

Paul von Hindenburg was the president of the Weimar Republic from the 12 May 1925 until his death on the 2 August 1934.

Courtesy of The Wiener Holocaust Library (<https://www.wienerlibrary.co.uk/>) Collections.

President Hindenburg died at the age of 87 on 2 August 1934.

Shortly after Hindenburg's death, Hitler announced that offices of the chancellor and the president were to be combined to create one position, the Führer and chancellor. Hitler announced that he would occupy this new role.

On 19 August 1934, the German people were asked to vote on whether or not they approved of the merging of the two offices and Hitler's new role as Führer. 95.7% of the population voted. 89.93% voted in favour of Hitler.

With Hindenburg gone, there was no longer a limit to Hitler's power. He was now a dictator.

(<https://www.facebook.com/sharer/sharer.php?u=https%3A%2F%2Fwww.theholocaustexplained.org%2Fthe-nazi-rise-to-power%2Fhow-did-the-nazi-gain-power%2Fgleichschaltung%2F>)
(<http://twitter.com/intent/tweet?text=Gleichschaltung&url=https%3A%2F%2Fwww.theholocaustexplained.org%2Fthe-nazi-rise-to-power%2Fhow-did-the-nazi-gain-power%2Fgleichschaltung%2F>)
 (<https://mail.google.com/mail/?ui=2&view=cm&fs=1&tf=1&su=Gleichschaltung&body=Link:https%3A%2F%2Fwww.theholocaustexplained.org%2Fthe-nazi-rise-to-power%2Fhow-did-the-nazi-gain-power%2Fgleichschaltung%2F>)

Themes of Nazi consolidation

The Nazis consolidation of power can be grouped into three main themes: pseudo-legality, terror and intimidation and pseudo-moderation.

Pseudo-legal

Germany feared revolution. As such, the Nazis' consolidation of power relied on maintaining the illusion of a stable democracy. This essentially meant that the Nazis used the atmosphere of panic following the Reichstag Fire (<https://www.theholocaustexplained.org/the-nazi-rise-to-power/how-did-the-nazi-gain-power/reichstag-fire/>) to put forward the Enabling Law (<https://www.theholocaustexplained.org/the-nazi-rise-to-power/how-did-the-nazi-gain-power/the-enabling-law/>). Once the Enabling Law was in place, the Nazis could bypass the Reichstag and rule by decree – seemingly creating laws that stabilised Germany and got rid of its 'internal enemies'. In reality, the laws that the Nazis put forward secured their future as the sole ruling party in Germany.

The support of respected individuals such as von Papen and Hindenburg's son, Oskar von Hindenburg, gave the Nazis further legitimacy for these actions.

The Nazis immediately used the Enabling Law to remove civil rights. This meant, as well as removing other personal freedoms, that the Nazis could now imprison their political opposition for an indefinite period for any, or no, reason. The Enabling Law allowed them to do this under the guise of legality. As such the Nazis justified this measure as implementing necessary security measures, rather than revealing their true motive – to remove opposition.

The Nazis' also took several more steps to reduce their political opposition 'legally'. On the 2 May 1933 trade unions were banned. Just two months later, on 14 July 1933 the Nazis used the Enabling Act to ban all political parties except the Nazi Party.

The Nazis also took steps to ensure they couldn't be openly opposed in the press. On the 4 October 1933, it was declared that all editors must be Aryan. Censorship was heightened, and any person publishing actively anti-Nazi material was threatened or imprisoned. By 1935, over 1,600 newspapers had been closed.

These acts removed people's ability to oppose the Nazi Party, in any form. However, it did so under the guise of legality, and 'protecting' the German people and their democracy.

Terror and intimidation

Whilst the pseudo-legal measures were one factor that helped the Nazi's to consolidate power, another was terror and intimidation.

The Nazi's used the SA and the newly expanded SS to harass and imprison any potential opponents of the Nazi Party. Following the Enabling Law, much of this harassment and imprisonment was legal.

In 1933, up to 200,000 people were seized and imprisoned by the SA and the SS. Prisons soon became stretched for space. The Nazis improvised. They used any space they could get their hands on to create temporary 'camps'. The first concentration camp, Dachau, opened in a broken-down munitions factory on the 20 March 1933, imprisoning primarily political prisoners.

The camps were brutal and had extremely unsanitary conditions. Many of the prisoners were tortured and abused.

Many of those that were harassed by the SA and the SS or imprisoned in camps were terrified to speak out about their ordeal – fearing that they would be further abused or re-imprisoned.

Terror and intimidation became one of the main ways that the Nazis sought to control or suppress their opposition, and German's in general.

Pseudo moderation

The Nazis used the guise of moderation (Avoiding extremes, acting in a way deemed to be reasonable.) to conceal their rapid consolidation of power.

One key example of an event posed as moderate was the Night of Long Knives.

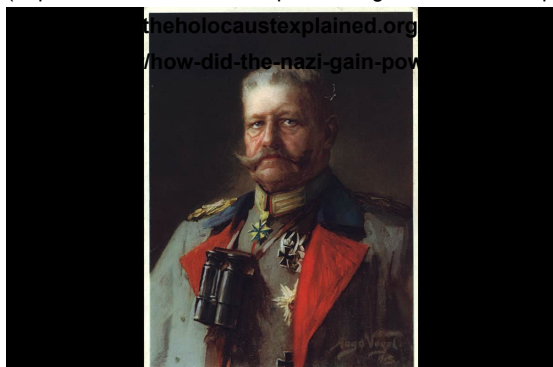
The Night of Long Knives was the purge of the SA leadership and other political opponents from the 30 June 1934 to the 2 July 1934. Over 150 people were murdered and hundreds more were arrested.

Following the purge, the Nazi's sculpted the media coverage to portray the event as a preventative measure against a revolutionary, violent, and uncontrollable force, rather than a series of political murders.

(<https://www.facebook.com/sharer/sharer.php?u=https%3A%2F%2Fwww.theholocaustexplained.org%2Fthe-nazi-rise-to-power%2Fhow-did-the-nazi-gain-power%2Fgleichschaltung%2F>)
(<http://twitter.com/intent/tweet?text=Gleichschaltung&url=https%3A%2F%2Fwww.theholocaustexplained.org%2Fthe-nazi-rise-to-power%2Fhow-did-the-nazi-gain-power%2Fgleichschaltung%2F>)
 (<https://mail.google.com/mail/?ui=2&view=cm&fs=1&tf=1&su=Gleichschaltung&body=Link:https%3A%2F%2Fwww.theholocaustexplained.org%2Fthe-nazi-rise-to-power%2Fhow-did-the-nazi-gain-power%2Fgleichschaltung%2F>)

Continue to next topic

(<https://www.theholocaustexplained.org/the-nazi-rise-to-power/how-did-the-nazi-gain-power/death-of-hindenburg/>)

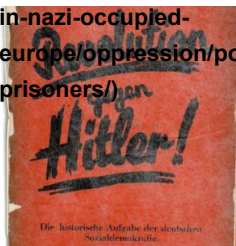


The death of President Hindenburg ►

📅 What happened in June



22 June 1933
in-nazi-occupied-
europe/oppression/po
prisoners/)



On 22 June 1933, the Nazis banned the Social Democratic Party of Germany.

30 June 1934
nazi-rise-to-
power/how-the
nazi-gain-
power/night-of-long-
knives/)



On 30 June 1934, the Night of Long Knives, a purge of the Nazi leadership by Hitler, took place.

28 June 1935
in-nazi-occupied-
europe/oppression/ho



On 28 June 1935, Paragraph 175 of the German Criminal Code was revised. This heightened the persecution of gay men.

22 June 1941
in-nazi-occupied-
europe/the-second-
world-war/invasion-
of-the-soviet-union/)



On 22 June 1941, the Nazis invaded the Soviet Union.

09 June 1942
in-nazi-occupie
europe/occupat
case-
studies/czecho



On 9 June 1942, the Nazis liquidated the Czech village of Lidice in response to the assassination of Reinhard Heydrich in Prague.

Resources

Educational Resources (<https://www.theholocaustexplained.org/educational-resources/>)
Timeline (<https://www.theholocaustexplained.org/timeline/>)
Survivor's stories (<https://www.theholocaustexplained.org/survivor-testimonies/>)
About us (<https://www.theholocaustexplained.org/about-us/>)
How to use this site (<https://www.theholocaustexplained.org/how-to-use-this-site/>)
Maps (<https://www.theholocaustexplained.org/maps/>)

Legal Information

Terms of use (<https://www.theholocaustexplained.org/terms-and-conditions/>)
Privacy & Security (<https://www.theholocaustexplained.org/privacy-and-security/>)
Legal Information (<https://www.theholocaustexplained.org/legal-information/>)
Online Safety (<https://www.theholocaustexplained.org/child-safety/>)

The Wiener
Holocaust Library

(<http://www.theholocaustexplained.org/>) (<http://wienerlibrary.co.uk/>)



(<https://www.lgfl.net/default.aspx>)